

Meridian & Associates LLP

Tax Services Practice

Tax Technology & Automation

Platform Architecture, RPA Implementation & Digital Tax Readiness
Modernizing the Tax Function

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1. Executive Summary

Meridian & Associates' Tax Technology & Automation (TTA) practice helps corporate tax departments transform their operations through the strategic implementation of tax technology platforms, robotic process automation (RPA), data analytics, and artificial intelligence. As tax authorities worldwide accelerate their adoption of digital tax administration -- including mandatory e-invoicing, real-time reporting, and SAF-T (Standard Audit File for Tax) requirements -- the imperative for corporate tax functions to modernize has never been greater. In FY2025, the TTA practice completed 85+ technology implementation engagements, achieving an average 40% reduction in tax return preparation time and a 55% reduction in manual data entry for clients adopting our recommended technology stack.

The technology solutions described in this document support and integrate with the firm's core tax service lines, including global compliance (M&A-TAX-GTC-001), transfer pricing (M&A-TAX-TPF-002), tax provision (M&A-TAX-PRV-003), M&A due diligence (M&A-TAX-MDD-004), credits and incentives (M&A-TAX-TCI-005), tax controversy (M&A-TAX-CON-006), SALT (M&A-TAX-SALT-008), and international tax planning (M&A-TAX-INTL-009).

2. Core Technology Platform -- Thomson Reuters ONESOURCE

Thomson Reuters ONESOURCE is the primary compliance and provision technology platform recommended by Meridian for large multinational tax departments. Our ONESOURCE implementation practice covers the full platform suite:

2.1 ONESOURCE Income Tax

We implement and optimize ONESOURCE Income Tax for corporate income tax compliance across US federal, US state and local, and international jurisdictions. Key implementation workstreams include: chart of accounts mapping and data integration with the client's general ledger and ERP system, template design and customization, automated workpaper generation, e-filing configuration, and multi-year migration from legacy platforms (GoSystem, Corptax, CCH Axcess). Our ONESOURCE Center of Excellence includes 35 certified consultants with an average of 12 years of implementation experience.

2.2 ONESOURCE Tax Provision

ONESOURCE Tax Provision (OTP) automates the ASC 740 quarterly and annual income tax provision process, including effective tax rate computation, deferred tax roll-forward, return-to-provision analysis, and financial statement disclosure preparation. We configure OTP to align with the client's organizational structure (entity-by-entity, consolidated group, or hybrid), establish automated data feeds from the consolidation system (HFM, OneStream, SAP BPC), and design custom reports and dashboards for the VP of Tax and CFO. Post-implementation, we provide annual update and optimization services covering new legislation, rate changes, and M&A structural changes.

2.3 ONESOURCE DataFlow

DataFlow serves as the data integration layer connecting the client's ERP, general ledger, and other source systems to ONESOURCE Income Tax and Tax Provision. We design and implement DataFlow extraction, transformation, and loading (ETL) routines that automate the mapping of GL accounts to tax return line items, reducing manual data entry by 80-90% for clients with well-structured ERP data. Our implementation methodology includes data quality assessment, reconciliation checkpoint design, and exception handling workflows.

3. Indirect Tax -- Vertex Tax Engine

For indirect tax (sales and use tax, VAT, GST) automation, we implement and configure the Vertex O Series and Vertex Cloud platforms. Our Vertex practice addresses:

- Tax determination engine integration -- embedding Vertex's real-time tax calculation engine into the client's order-to-cash and

procure-to-pay processes via SAP, Oracle, Salesforce, or custom API integration.

- Product taxability mapping -- classification of the client's products and services under Vertex's commodity taxonomy, including analysis of exemptions, reduced rates, and jurisdiction-specific rules.
- Exemption certificate management -- implementation of Vertex's exemption certificate module (or integration with CertCapture/Avalara) to automate the collection, validation, and renewal of customer exemption certificates.
- Returns automation -- configuration of Vertex Returns for automated preparation and e-filing of sales and use tax returns across all applicable jurisdictions, including reconciliation to GL and Vertex transaction data.
- Global indirect tax -- for multinational clients, implementation of Vertex's O Series for global VAT/GST determination, supporting compliance with EU VAT Directive, UK MTD (Making Tax Digital), and other international indirect tax requirements.

4. Data Transformation -- Alteryx

Alteryx Designer and Alteryx Server are deployed as the primary data transformation and analytics platform for tax data preparation workflows. Common Alteryx use cases in the tax function include:

- Trial balance normalization -- transforming raw GL trial balance exports from multiple ERP instances into a standardized format for import into ONESOURCE or provision workpapers.
- Fixed asset analysis -- processing large fixed asset registers (100,000+ assets) for depreciation schedule computation, cost segregation reclassification, and Section 168 bonus depreciation optimization.
- R&D credit documentation -- automated extraction and analysis of project time-tracking data, payroll records, and contractor invoices to identify and quantify qualified research expenditures.
- State apportionment factor computation -- automated compilation of sales, payroll, and property factors from multiple source systems, including market-based sourcing analysis for service and intangible income.
- Transfer pricing benchmarking data preparation -- extraction and cleaning of comparable company data from Orbis/TP Catalyst for TNMM analysis.
- M&A due diligence data analysis -- rapid analysis of target company trial balances, fixed asset registers, and intercompany transaction logs during the compressed due diligence timeline.

Our Alteryx Center of Excellence maintains a library of 200+ reusable workflow templates covering common tax data preparation scenarios, reducing implementation time for new client deployments by 50-60%.

5. Tax Dashboards -- Power BI

We design and deploy Microsoft Power BI dashboards for tax department performance management and executive reporting. Standard dashboard packages include:

- Global Tax Compliance Dashboard -- real-time visibility into filing status, deadlines, reviewer assignments, and extension tracking across all jurisdictions. Color-coded status indicators (green/yellow/red) with drill-down capability to individual entity and return level.
- Effective Tax Rate Dashboard -- visual ETR bridge analysis (waterfall chart from statutory rate to effective rate), trend analysis across quarters, and variance commentary. Enables the VP of Tax to explain ETR movements to the CFO and Audit Committee in real time.
- Tax Controversy Tracker -- status of all open audits, appeals cases, and refund claims, including aging analysis, exposure quantification, and reserve adequacy monitoring.
- Transfer Pricing Monitoring Dashboard -- comparison of actual intercompany transaction results against benchmarked arm's length ranges, with automated exception alerts when results fall outside the interquartile range.
- Tax Credit and Incentive Tracker -- consolidated view of all claimed and available tax credits and incentives, including compliance milestone tracking, expiration dates, and projected cash flow impact.

6. Robotic Process Automation (RPA)

6.1 RPA for Return Assembly

Our RPA practice leverages UiPath and Microsoft Power Automate to automate repetitive, rules-based tasks in the tax compliance process. The flagship use case -- automated return assembly -- has achieved an average 40% reduction in tax return preparation time across 120+ client implementations. The return assembly bot performs the following tasks:

- Extraction of trial balance data from the ERP system and population into the tax compliance workpapers.
- Automated workpaper cross-referencing -- linking supporting schedules to return line items and flagging discrepancies.
- PDF assembly -- compiling the final return package including the signed return, supporting schedules, state apportionment worksheets, election statements, and disclosure forms.
- Filing checklist automation -- populating filing checklists with return data, generating quality review prompts, and routing for electronic approval.
- E-filing submission -- automated submission of completed returns to the IRS Modernized e-File (MeF) system and state e-filing portals.

6.2 Additional RPA Use Cases

Beyond return assembly, we have implemented RPA solutions for:

- Notices and correspondence processing -- automated extraction of data from IRS and state tax authority notices (CP2000, balance due notices, penalty assessments), classification by issue type, and routing to the appropriate engagement team.
- Sales tax exemption certificate processing -- automated validation of certificate completeness, expiration date monitoring, and renewal request generation.
- Withholding tax reclaim processing -- automated preparation of reclaim forms for excess withholding on cross-border payments (dividends, interest, royalties) under applicable tax treaties.
- Estimated tax payment monitoring -- automated tracking of federal and state estimated tax payment deadlines, computation of required installments (Section 6655 safe harbor calculations), and payment initiation through the client's treasury system.

7. AI-Assisted Tax Research

Meridian has developed and deployed AI-powered tax research tools that augment the capabilities of our tax professionals:

- Meridian TaxAI Research Assistant -- a large language model fine-tuned on Meridian's proprietary knowledge base of 50,000+ technical memoranda, tax court decisions, IRS guidance documents, and engagement work products. The assistant provides natural-language responses to complex tax research questions, with citations to primary authority, and is available to all Meridian tax professionals through a secure internal portal.
- Automated authority monitoring -- AI-powered scanning of daily tax developments (legislation, regulations, rulings, decisions) with automated classification by topic, jurisdiction, and client impact. High-impact developments trigger automated alerts to relevant engagement teams.
- Predictive audit analytics -- machine learning models trained on historical audit data to predict audit selection risk, IRS focus areas, and likely proposed adjustment amounts, enabling proactive audit preparation and reserve optimization.
- Document review acceleration -- AI-assisted review of transaction documents (intercompany agreements, M&A purchase agreements, loan documents) to extract key tax terms and flag potential issues, reducing manual review time by 60-70%.

8. Digital Tax Administration Readiness

8.1 E-Invoicing Mandates

Governments worldwide are rapidly implementing mandatory electronic invoicing (e-invoicing) and real-time transaction reporting.

As of early 2026, e-invoicing is mandatory in over 50 jurisdictions including Mexico (CFDI), Brazil (NF-e), Italy (SDI), India (e-Invoice), Saudi Arabia (ZATCA/Fatoora), and the EU (ViDA -- VAT in the Digital Age, phased implementation 2028-2032). Our e-invoicing readiness assessment covers:

- Gap analysis -- comparison of the client's current invoicing process against the technical and format requirements of each applicable mandate (Peppol BIS, UBL 2.1, CII Cross Industry Invoice, country-specific schemas).
- Platform selection -- evaluation of e-invoicing platforms (Sovos, Pagero/Thomson Reuters, Avalara, Comarch, SAP Document Compliance) based on geographic coverage, ERP integration capabilities, and scalability.
- Implementation roadmap -- phased deployment plan prioritized by mandate effective dates and penalty severity, with integration to the client's ERP and Vertex/ONESOURCE indirect tax engine.
- Ongoing compliance monitoring -- continuous monitoring of regulatory changes and platform updates to ensure sustained compliance as mandates evolve.

8.2 ERP Integration Architecture

The effectiveness of any tax technology solution depends on seamless integration with the client's enterprise systems. Our integration architecture practice designs and implements connections between:

- ERP to tax compliance -- real-time or batch data flows from SAP S/4HANA, Oracle Cloud, Microsoft Dynamics 365, or Workday Financials to ONESOURCE, Vertex, and other tax engines.
- Tax compliance to financial reporting -- automated journal entry generation from tax provision calculations, with posting to the GL and consolidation system.
- Tax to treasury -- integration of estimated tax payment schedules, refund tracking, and tax cash flow forecasts into the client's treasury management system (Kyriba, FIS, ION).
- Document management -- centralized storage of tax returns, workpapers, election statements, and correspondence in the client's document management system (SharePoint, OpenText, iManage) with appropriate access controls and retention policies.

All integrations follow our standardized API-first architecture, leveraging RESTful APIs and middleware platforms (MuleSoft, Dell Boomi, Microsoft Azure Integration Services) to ensure scalability, auditability, and maintainability. Each integration includes comprehensive error handling, reconciliation checkpoints, and automated monitoring with alerting. All tax technology implementations adhere to the firm's information security standards (see [common_firm_wide/infosec_overview.pdf](#)) and client data handling policies (see [common_firm_wide/data_privacy_policy.pdf](#)).